STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-13400
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED **08/23/24**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: DIGITAL FORENSICS UNIT		RESOURCES		
SUBJECT DFU REQUESTS FOR SERVICES		CROSS REFERENCE		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for requesting the services of the Digital Forensics Unit (DFU)

II. Policy:

This policy outlines the procedures for requesting the services of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Digital Forensics Unit (DFU) for the proper downloading and extraction of digital evidence from devices for criminal investigations. Official requests for assistance must be submitted in accordance with the guidelines provided herein.

III. Procedure:

1. Request Submission

a) All requests for digital forensic assistance from the DFU must be submitted in writing to the "Sheriff Digital Forensics" email distribution group. The requesting party, typically an Investigator or Deputy, shall provide the necessary information to initiate the process.

b) Requests for digital forensic assistance shall include the following details:

(1) Report Number: The unique identification number assigned to the investigation.

(2) Type of Investigation: A brief description of the nature of the investigation.

(3) Device(s) to be Extracted: Specify the digital devices (e.g., cell phone, computer, GPS unit) for which extraction is requested.

(4) Legal Authority: Clearly state the legal basis for conducting the download, such as a search warrant or written consent. Copies of the search warrant or written consent must be attached to the email.

2. Optional Analysis Request

a) If analysis by a member of the DFU is requested, the submitting Investigator/Deputy shall provide a clear description of the specific information or evidence they seek to extract or identify from the digital device(s). This description should include details about files, applications, communications, or any other relevant data to guide the forensic examination.

3. If no analysis is requested, a copy of a “Reader Report” will be placed on a digital storage device and provided to the originating Investigator.

4. Timeliness of Requests

a) Requests for digital forensic services should be submitted as soon as possible after determining the need for such assistance. Timely submission will enable the DFU to allocate resources effectively and ensure the preservation of digital evidence.

5. Review and Approval

a) The DFU will review the submitted request to ensure it meets the specified criteria and includes all required information. Incomplete or insufficient requests may be returned to the requesting party for clarification.

6. Prioritization and Scheduling

a) Upon approval of the request, the DFU will prioritize and schedule the extraction and analysis tasks based on the urgency of the investigation and available resources. The requesting party will be notified of the estimated timeframe for completion.

b) The DFU will maintain open communication with the requesting party throughout the process. Updates on the progress of the digital evidence extraction and analysis will be provided as necessary.

7. Documentation

a) Upon completion of the digital forensic tasks, the DFU will provide a detailed report outlining the procedures undertaken, the results obtained,

and any relevant findings. This report will be provided to the requesting party for inclusion in the investigative case file.